05 — Roadmap & Financial Projections

From pilot validation to DACH/EU expansion

> ⚠ **ALL FIGURES BELOW ARE ILLUSTRATIVE PLACEHOLDERS**
>
> Sized to a plausible NRW polymer-compliance SaaS trajectory — not audited, not based on signed contracts. Replace with the team's own bottom-up model before any binding submission.

Phase 0 — Foundation COMPLETE

Already delivered

- Core platform live: passport data model, cryptographic audit ledger, GS1 QR/Digital Link engine, certification workflow, auditor & buyer portals, ESG/compliance analytics, supplier onboarding, multi-language public page.

Phase 1 — Pilot validation NEXT

Months 1–6

- Onboard 3–5 pilot manufacturer customers across compounding, recycling, and converting
- Onboard a small initial auditor network (2–4 auditors or one firm)
- Formalize the RWTH Aachen / CCE advisory relationship
- Harden production-grade session auth; complete first external security review
- File the first NRW.BANK / EFRE.NRW / Ressource.NRW application(s)

Phase 2 — Regional scale-up

Months 7–18

- Convert pilots to paying subscriptions; expand sales across the NRW Mittelstand base
- Ship the Buyer API/CSRD-integration tier commercially with an anchor OEM/converter
- Complete first-class batch-weight field & full mass-based ESG coverage
- Formalize the auditor network into a structured, trained program

Phase 3 — DACH/EU expansion

Months 19–36

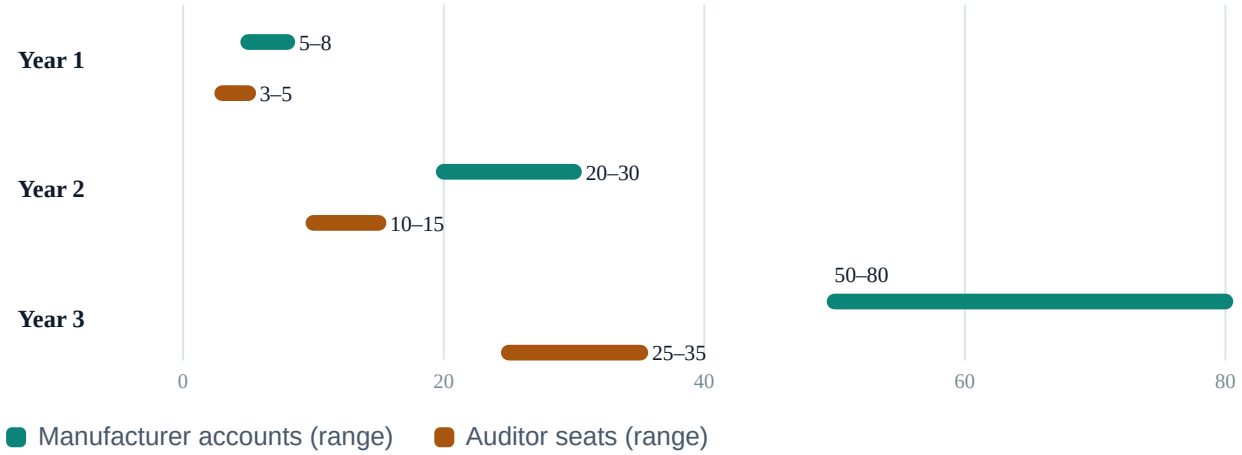
- Expand into the wider DACH chemical cluster on NRW reference customers
- Evaluate white-label/multi-tenant licensing as a second growth vector
- Pursue a follow-on research/translation grant on the platform's verified dataset
- Reassess entry into Benelux/broader EU as ESPR delegated acts take effect there

Milestone summary

MILESTONE	TARGET	SUCCESS SIGNAL
First 3–5 pilot manufacturer customers live	Month 3–6	Real production batches issued, not demo data
Session auth + external security review complete	Month 6	No critical findings outstanding
First paying subscription conversions	Month 6–9	≥1 pilot converts to paid
Buyer API live with ≥1 anchor buyer	Month 12–15	A real OEM/converter consuming verified data
Auditor network formalized (≥5 active)	Month 12–18	Verification turnaround SLA published
NRW.BANK/EFRE.NRW-type grant secured	Month 6–12	Co-financing awarded, reporting in place
DACH expansion sales motion launched	Month 18–24	First non-NRW paying customer

Illustrative financial projections

A simple, transparent structure: a per-manufacturer-account monthly subscription (blended across tiers), a smaller per-seat auditor line, and a services/API line that grows as the Buyer API matures.



Illustrative ranges only — not audited, not based on signed contracts. See the milestone table above for the conditions each range assumes.

	YEAR 1	YEAR 2	YEAR 3
Paying manufacturer accounts (year-end)	5–8	20–30	50–80
Auditor seats (year-end)	3–5	10–15	25–35
Buyer API / services revenue	Pilot only	Growing	Established line
Primary cost drivers	Engineering, domain expertise, infra	+ sales, customer success, security review	+ partnerships, DACH expansion costs
Grant co-financing role	Bridges pilot-phase cost gap	Supports scale-up & security hardening	Supports expansion-phase R&D

Modeling notes for the team — replace before submission

- Anchor subscription tiers to actual pilot pricing conversations, not a top-down guess — B2B pricing here is usually set by the customer's cost of *non-compliance*, not a generic SaaS benchmark.
- Build the cost-structure line items into an actual monthly burn model before stating any runway or grant-need figure — NRW.BANK/EFRE.NRW applications typically require a documented use-of-funds breakdown.
- State a specific funding ask only after checking the current ceiling and co-financing rate of the target program — do not carry a number from this template into a real application.
- Where a program requires job-creation or regional-impact projections, derive those from the headcount line rather than a separate, disconnected number.